

In this Month's

EFY^{CD}

Focus on PCB Design and Software Development

TOP 5 SOFTWARE

Active HDL



Target 3001



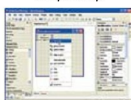
MicroCap



Lazarus



SharpDevelop



Active HDL. Active-HDL is a completely integrated FPGA design and verification solution, providing ease-of-use, advanced verification and debugging capabilities for today's complex FPGA designs. It supports simulation, synthesis and implementation of all devices from Altera, Lattice, Quicklogic, Xilinx and other FPGA vendors. Certain interesting features of this software are HDL simulator, pre-compiled FPGA vendor libraries, code2graphics, graphics2code, and HTML and PDF design simulation.

Target 3001. TARGET 3001 CAD software for PCB design features schematic capture, mixed-mode simulation, auto-routing, auto-placement, PCB layout, 3D view, basic EMC check and front-panel layout capabilities. It provides manufacturing data for production processes of all industry standards.

MicroCap. Micro-Cap 9 is an integrated schematic editor and mixed-analogue/digital simulator that provides an interactive sketch-and-simulate environment. Compared to its earlier versions, it includes algorithm improvements and optimised code.

Lazarus. The Lazarus IDE is a stable and feature-rich visual programming environment for the Free-Pascal compiler. It includes a syntax-highlighting code editor and visual form designer, as well as a component library. It supports the creation of self-standing graphical and console applications and runs on Linux, FreeBSD, MacOSX and Windows.

SharpDevelop. SharpDevelop IDE for .NET framework applications supports the development of applications written in C# and Visual Basic. NET. It is open-source and written in C#. It provides all of the features required from a modern Windows IDE, such as code completion, project templates, an integrated debugger and a forms designer. It has good compatibility with Visual Studio Express and Visual Studio 2005 by using the same project and solution file format.

CodeBlocks. CodeBlocks is a free C++ IDE that is built around a plugin framework and can be extended with plugins. Any kind of functionality can be added by installing/coding a plugin. For instance, compiling and debugging functionality is already provided by plugins.